

Here's What Android KitKat Brings To The Table

KitKat is the biggest Android release since Ice Cream Sandwich. Google has touched nearly every part of the OS in some way, so there's a lot to cover. Let us take a peek at some of the prominent features in this release.



Android is the operating system that powers over 1 billion smartphones and tablets. It now controls nearly 80 per cent of the smartphone market and half of the tablet market, according to IDC and Gartner. After three Jelly Bean releases in a row, Google has unleashed a major revision to its hugely popular mobile OS—Android KitKat or Android 4.4.

Google recently announced that both the 2012 and 2013 editions of Nexus 7 as well as Nexus 10 will be shortly getting the upgrades for 4.4. A manual upgrade is also expected to be available soon for both Nexus 7 and Nexus 10, something that will allow users to bypass the OTA upgrade.

A refined and polished user experience

The launcher screen on Google KitKat's flagship device, Nexus 5, has transparent status and system bars with a gradient effect as opposed to the black bars in Jelly Bean. The status bar icons are now white. This gives KitKat an overall brighter look.

The line separating the dock and the rest of the home

screen is replaced with dots that indicate the current home screen being displayed, quite similar to iOS. There's no limit to the number of home screens one can add. A new home screen can be added just by dragging an app icon out of the app drawer. However, no fast scroll is supported for either the home screen or the widgets screen.

The home screen dot pagination is present in the Nexus 5 app drawer, too. Currently, dots are mere indicators and touching the dots does nothing. The app drawer displays a slightly darker version of the home screen wallpaper as opposed to the complete black background in Jelly Bean.

The new launcher on Nexus 5 contains huge icons and there are no tabs for *Apps* and *Widgets* as in Jelly Bean. The widgets become available on long pressing anywhere on the home screen.

Also, Android's UI now stays hidden whenever you're interacting with content. Essentially, there are no system and status bars; the application is able to utilise the full screen entirely.